

Sahil Walia

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EDUCATION

Master of Science in Business Analytics (GPA: 3.76/4.0)

Aug 2024 - May 2025

W.P. Carey School of Business, Arizona State University, AZ, USA

Bachelor of Technology - Automotive Engineering

Jul 2016 - Jun 2020

SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Chennai, TN, India

• **82.12% - First Class with Distinction**

EXPERIENCE

AI Model Validation Expert (RLHF) - Handshake AI Fellow

Nov 2025 - Present

- Lead a team of 15 members to architect Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback preference modeling pipelines for leading frontier labs, accelerating GenAI response optimization across multimodal LLM outputs.
- Spearheaded comprehensive AI model evaluation across diverse performance benchmarks, delivering 2,500+ peer-reviewed preference data points over 1,500+ hours of rigorous model validation and alignment testing.
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to define robust AI safety alignment benchmarks, evaluating reward model calibration to minimize optimization drift and ensure adherence to ethical AI standards.

Decision Analytics Associate Consultant - ZS Associates

Jan 2024 - Jun 2024

- Designed Business Intelligence pipelines and integrated analytics solutions for \$50M+ initiatives, blending clinical and real-world data to drive executive decision-making and improve patient recruitment outcomes by 30%.
- Architected data governance and reporting frameworks for clinical and census data using Tableau, ensuring data integrity and consistency across diverse patient recruitment workstreams.
- Implemented robust data quality checks and validation protocols within automated SQL pipelines, eliminating manual reporting dependencies and ensuring high-fidelity data for executive insights.
- Acted as a strategic advisor between IT and business units, translating complex data into impactful narratives and actionable recommendations for senior leadership.

Decision Analytics Associate - ZS Associates

Jan 2023 - Dec 2023

- Developed enterprise BI dashboards and Alteryx powered analytics solutions, enabling real-time monitoring of prescription trends, payer dynamics, and HCP engagement across multiple geographies.
- Synthesized brand portfolio data into standardized performance scorecards using Alteryx for automated data preparation, utilizing Snowflake environment to support competitive intelligence for portfolios exceeding \$100M.
- Led the end-to-end delivery of 120+ concurrent initiatives using Agile methodology, managing stakeholder expectations and resource requirements across global geographies.

Business Operations Associate - ZS Associates

May 2021 - Dec 2022

- Partnered with external vendors to oversee technical integrations, leveraging Alteryx workflows streamlining operations and reducing regulatory preparation timelines from weeks to days.
- Designed data models and reporting frameworks to track 110+ R&D initiatives within an oncology portfolio, providing executive-level visibility into a \$75M+ development pipeline.
- Implemented standardized data management and reporting processes using Excel/VBA, SQL, and Tableau, reducing manual effort by 30% through enhanced data accessibility and governance.
- Facilitated global alignment by coordinating with virtual teams to standardize reporting processes and enhance data accessibility for an oncology development pipeline.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

- **Student Research Volunteer (Sep 2025 - Mar 2026):** Researching XAI techniques and utilizing publicly available mammogram datasets to improve model interpretability and support early-stage cancer diagnosis.
- **Harley-Davidson Capstone - AI Sentiment Analyzer (Jan 2025 - May 2025):** Enabled data-driven marketing and R&D decisions by extracting consumer insights from large-scale social media data using NLP-based sentiment analysis (RoBERTa, BERT).

SKILLS

- **Business Intelligence & Data Visualization:** Tableau, Power BI, Alteryx, Excel (Advanced Macros/VBA), KPI Design, SQL, Python, Storyboarding, Executive Presentations
- **Data Management & Governance:** Data Governance Frameworks, Data Quality Management, Data Lifecycle, Data Cataloging, SharePoint Center of Excellence
- **Strategic Operations:** Business Writing, Hypothesis Development, Feasibility Reviews, Process Mapping, Financial Analysis, Data Governance
- **Project Management & Tools:** Agile (Scrum/Kanban), Jira, Smartsheet, Stakeholder Management, Vendor Management, UAT, Virtual Collaboration

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google - Business Intelligence, Coursera - 2025
- IBM - AI Foundations for Everyone, Coursera - 2025
- Tableau Certified Data Analyst, Salesforce - 2023